



30 million, its population is the smallest of any continent. The area is made up of Australia, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea, and thousands of islands in the Pacific Ocean. These islands are divided into three

main areas: Micronesia, Melanesia, and Polynesia. Australia is too large to be called an island and is now considered a continent in its own right, and with the other islands, is known as Oceania.

0 km 400 800  
0 miles 400 800

The world's biggest atoll is Kwajalein, in the Marshall Islands. An atoll is a ring of coral enclosing a central lagoon.

### Melanesia

Five main island groups make up Melanesia — Papua New Guinea, Fiji, Vanuatu, New Caledonia, and the Solomon Islands.

## The Pacific and Australia statistics



### POPULATION BY COUNTRY

Although Australia has the most amount of people, it is also by far the largest country and has a small population for its size.

|                  |            |
|------------------|------------|
| Australia        | 19 million |
| Papua New Guinea | 5 million  |
| Tokelau          | 1,500      |
| Pitcairn Islands | 47         |

### Polynesia

This area covers the Cook Islands, French Polynesia, Easter Island, and Pitcairn Islands, among other small island groups.

### NUMBER OF LANGUAGES

There are an extraordinary amount of languages spoken in this part of the world, Papua New Guinea taking first prize!

|                  |     |
|------------------|-----|
| Papua New Guinea | 823 |
| Australia        | 237 |
| Vanuatu          | 109 |
| Solomon Islands  | 69  |

### URBAN POPULATION

Australia and New Zealand dominate the largest urban areas, but compared to the rest of the world, they have small populations.

|                |             |
|----------------|-------------|
| Sydney, Aus    | 4.1 million |
| Melbourne, Aus | 3.5 million |
| Brisbane, Aus  | 1.7 million |
| Auckland, NZ   | 1.1 million |

### RELIGIONS

The majority of the people in this area choose to be Christian, introduced by the missionaries and the colonists.

|                    |              |
|--------------------|--------------|
| Protestant         | 14.6 million |
| Roman Catholic     | 7.4 million  |
| Indigenous beliefs | 3.5 million  |
| Hindu              | 430,000      |

